

A blue square chip with the letters 'AI' in white, surrounded by circuit lines.A 3D pie chart with three segments: blue, purple, and white.

AI for

Business Analysis



COMPETITOR ANALYSIS

&

SWOT

THINK LIKE A BUSINESS ANALYST

AI can help you find information faster — but the strategy is still **YOUR** decision.



Good decisions come from
insight + judgment.

A REAL SITUATION

You have started a company.
Your product is good. Your price is reasonable.
Your Instagram page looks great.



But then you discover something:
**There are already five companies
selling almost the same thing.**

NOW WHAT?



You need to understand your competitors
before investing time, money, and energy.



WHY COMPETITOR ANALYSIS IS CRUCIAL



Who are your **competitors**?



What are they doing **better**?



What are they doing **poorly**?



Why would students **choose you**?



What **opportunities** exist?



What could **destroy** your business?



YOUR STARTUP IDEA

Food-Delivery Business for College Students

*"Affordable meals delivered to
college students within 20 minutes."*



COMPETITOR ANALYSIS = KNOW THE MARKET, FIND YOUR EDGE, WIN SMARTER

WHAT IS COMPETITOR ANALYSIS?



Very simply: Competitor analysis means studying businesses that **compete for the same customers.**



Remember:

It's not about the product.
It's about the **customer** and their choices.

EXAMPLE: COFFEE SHOP NEAR A COLLEGE

Your competitors could include:



Starbucks



Local cafés



College canteen



Small tea shops



Food-delivery apps

THINK LIKE YOUR CUSTOMER

Notice something interesting.

A student doesn't necessarily think:
"I need **Starbucks.**"



They think:
"I want something to **eat or drink.**"

So different businesses can compete for the **same customer spending.**



ASK YOURSELF



If you open a **burger restaurant**, who are your competitors?



Don't just think of **other burger restaurants.**

Think:

"Where else could your customer spend that ₹200?"

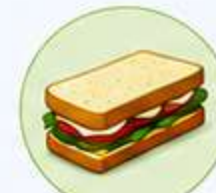
Maybe:



Pizza



Momos



Sandwiches



Café



Canteen



That's business thinking.

Understand the customer. Understand the choices. **Win the market.**

DIRECT VS. INDIRECT COMPETITORS



Understanding your competitors helps you **find your edge** and **win your customers**.

DIRECT COMPETITOR



Offers a **similar product** to a **similar customer**.

EXAMPLE:

Burger King vs McDonald's



VS



They are competing for the same customer with almost the **same kind of product**.

INDIRECT COMPETITOR



Offers a **different product** but solves a **similar customer need**.

EXAMPLE:

McDonald's vs a local pizza shop



VS



Both may compete for the same customer thought: **"I want a quick and affordable meal."**



QUESTION FOR YOU

Imagine you're launching an **online clothing store** for college students.



Who could be your **direct competitors**?



Who could be your **indirect competitors**?



The better you understand your competitors, the **better you can serve your customers**.

WHY DO BUSINESSES STUDY COMPETITORS?

Because customers have choices.
Our goal is to be their **best choice**.

REAL-LIFE SITUATION

Your Competitor
sells for

₹999



You sell the
same type of product for

₹1,499



Is that automatically bad? **Not necessarily.**

MAYBE YOU OFFER MORE VALUE IN WAYS THAT MATTER TO YOUR CUSTOMER



Better
quality



Faster
delivery



Better
packaging



Better customer
service



Stronger
brand



Longer
warranty



Competitor analysis helps you understand:
"Why would the customer choose us instead of them?"



That's the
REAL QUESTION.



Study competitors. **Learn** from them. **Differentiate**. **Deliver** more value. **Win** the customer.

COMPETITOR BENCHMARKING

Benchmarking means **comparing** your business against competitors using **specific factors**.



Example:

Comparing three food-delivery companies.

FACTOR	COMPANY A	COMPANY B	COMPANY C
 Price	Low	Medium	High
 Delivery	Fast	Medium	Fast
 App experience	Good	Excellent	Good
 Variety	High	High	Medium
 Discounts	High	Medium	Low



The goal is not to be the same as everyone.
The goal is to be **better where it matters**.

THE PURPOSE IS NOT...



to simply say,
"Company B is better."

THE REAL PURPOSE IS...



to ask,
**"Where are we stronger
and where are we weaker?"**



Benchmarking gives you
clarity, direction and focus
to make smarter decisions.



BENCHMARK ≠ COPY

Learn from competitors. Take ideas. Improve them.

Build your own edge.

AI CAN MAKE COMPETITOR RESEARCH FASTER



AI gives you a **quick starting framework** so you can focus on **strategy**, not searching.



AI is a **powerful assistant**.
You are the **decision maker**.



EXAMPLE AI PROMPT

You can ask AI something like this:

“

'I am analyzing **Zomato's** competitive position in **India's food-delivery market**.

Identify its major competitors and compare them on:

1. Pricing
2. Customer experience
3. Delivery
4. Product/service variety
5. Brand positioning
6. Technology
7. Customer segments
8. Key differentiators

Clearly separate **verified facts** from your **analysis**.

Do not invent statistics.

Mention **sources** wherever possible.

”



WHAT AI CAN GIVE YOU (STARTING FRAMEWORK)

FACTORS	zomato	SWIGGY	zepto	Uber Eats	OTHERS
Pricing	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Customer experience	✓	✓	✓	✓	—
Delivery	✓	✓	✓	—	—
Product/service variety	✓	✓	—	✓	—
Brand positioning	✓	✓	✓	✓	—
Technology	✓	✓	✓	—	—
Customer segments	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Key differentiators	—	—	—	—	—



AI gives you a **structured view** with comparative points to start your analysis **quickly**.



IMPORTANT:

Don't believe everything AI tells you.



Cross-check
every fact.



Go to **original**
sources.



Look for
recent data.



Use **multiple**
credible sources.



REMEMBER:

AI accelerates research, but **human judgment**, **verification** and **strategy** build the winning business.

AI CAN BE WRONG ABOUT COMPETITORS ⚠️

AI is a **powerful assistant**, but it can make mistakes or provide outdated/incomplete information.

EXAMPLE SCENARIO



"Company A has
70% market share."

Would you immediately put that
into your presentation?

NO ❌

WHAT YOU SHOULD DO



NUMBERS CAN MEAN VERY DIFFERENT THINGS

Make sure you **understand what the number** actually refers to.



REVENUE

Total money earned.
(e.g., ₹ in crores)



ORDERS

Total number of
orders placed.



USERS

Total registered
or active users.



ONE PARTICULAR CITY

Market share in
one city only.



ONE PARTICULAR YEAR

Market share in
one specific year.



IMPORTANT RULE

AI-generated competitive claims are **HYPOTHESES**
until you **VERIFY** them.



WHY THIS MATTERS

Accurate insights lead to **better decisions**.
Always **verify** before you rely.



REMEMBER:

AI gives you a **starting point**. Verification gives you **the truth**. Truth drives **strategy**.

NOW LET'S UNDERSTAND SWOT

SWOT is one of the most common business analysis frameworks.

SWOT STANDS FOR:

S – Strengths

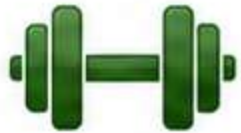
W – Weaknesses

O – Opportunities

T – Threats

S

STRENGTHS



Internal factors that give the company an advantage over others.



Examples: Strong brand, good team, technology, customer trust

W

WEAKNESSES



Internal factors that put the company at a disadvantage compared to others.



Examples: High costs, poor processes, limited resources, weak brand

O

OPPORTUNITIES



External factors in the market that the company can use to grow and succeed.



Examples: Growing market, new trends, new technology, untapped customers

T

THREATS



External factors that can cause problems or risk to the business.



Examples: New competitors, economic slowdown, changing customer behavior



WHY SWOT IS IMPORTANT?

It helps businesses understand their current position and plan smart strategies for the future.



DON'T MEMORIZE THE FOUR WORDS YET.

Let's understand them through a company in the upcoming slides.

STRENGTHS (S)

Strengths are **internal** things the company does well.

WHAT ARE STRENGTHS?



They are the **internal advantages** that give the company an edge over others.

EXAMPLES OF STRENGTHS

 Strong brand	 Loyal customers
 Good technology	 Large distribution network
 Skilled employees	 Strong financial position
 Good product quality	

REAL-LIFE EXAMPLE

A student starts a small clothing business.



Their strength might be:

"I have a strong Instagram following among college students."



This is an **internal advantage**.

ASK YOURSELF



If you started a business tomorrow, what could be **your strength**?

Think about:



Your skills



Your network



Your technology



Your location



Your customer knowledge



Your unique idea



KEY TAKEAWAY

Strengths are what you are good at and what you already have. They are **within your control**. Use them as your **advantage**!

WEAKNESSES (W)

Weaknesses are **internal limitations** that put the company at a **disadvantage**.

WHAT ARE WEAKNESSES?



They are the **internal factors** that hold the company back or make it weaker compared to others.

EXAMPLES OF WEAKNESSES



Limited budget



Small team



Weak brand awareness



Poor distribution



Limited technology



Lack of experience

REAL-LIFE EXAMPLE

Imagine your startup has an amazing product.



Amazing Product



MARKETING BUDGET



₹50,000

But you only have ₹50,000 marketing budget.



That could be a **weakness**.

IMPORTANT DISTINCTION

A weakness is something **inside the business**.

Example:



Our Business



Delivery

"We don't have enough delivery staff."



This is an **internal weakness**.



KEY TAKEAWAY

Weaknesses are the areas where you are lacking. Identify them honestly so you can **improve** and become **stronger**.

0 OPPORTUNITIES (0)

Opportunities are **external situations** that the company could potentially **take advantage of**.



You don't create opportunities.
The **market** creates them.

WHAT ARE OPPORTUNITIES?



They are **external factors** in the environment that the company can use to grow and succeed.

EXAMPLES OF OPPORTUNITIES



Growing market
The overall market is expanding.



New technology
New tech can improve products or reduce costs.



Changing consumer behavior
Shifts in what customers want create new possibilities.



New customer segment
A new group of customers you can serve.



New geographic market
Expanding to new cities, countries, or regions.



New regulations creating demand
Laws or policies that create new needs.



Competitor leaving a market
Less competition or a gap in the market.

REAL-LIFE EXAMPLE

Imagine college students increasingly want **affordable healthy food**.



If you're running a healthy-food startup:



Growing demand =
OPPORTUNITY



Notice something important.
You **don't control** the opportunity.
The **market** creates it.

KEY POINTS TO REMEMBER

- ✓ Opportunities come from **outside** the business.
- ✓ They are situations or trends you can **take advantage of**.
- ✓ They can help you **grow, expand, or innovate**.
- ✓ Not all opportunities fit your business. Choose the **right ones**.
- ✓ Acting early on opportunities gives you a **competitive edge**.

EXAMPLE IN ACTION



Trend:
More students want healthy, affordable food



Your Insight:
There is a gap you can fill



Your Move:
Launch a healthy food brand



KEY TAKEAWAY

Look around. Spot changes in the market, technology, customers, and regulations.
Turn those changes into growth opportunities!



T THREATS (T)

Threats are **external factors** that could **negatively affect** the business.

WHAT ARE THREATS?



They are **external factors** in the environment that could harm the business or make it harder to achieve its goals.

EXAMPLES OF THREATS



New competitors



Price wars



Changing regulations



Economic slowdown



Changing customer preferences



Technology disruption



Supply-chain problems

REAL-LIFE EXAMPLE

Imagine you're running a **traditional taxi company**.



Traditional
Taxi Company

Ride-Hailing
Apps



Then ride-hailing apps become extremely popular.



That's an **external threat**.
It can reduce your customers,
revenue, and market share.

KEY POINTS TO REMEMBER



Threats come from **outside** the business.



They are **risks** that can create problems or reduce performance.



You cannot control threats, but you can **prepare** for them.



Ignoring threats can lead to **big losses**.



The key is to **identify threats early** and build a strong response plan.

MORE EXAMPLES IN ACTION



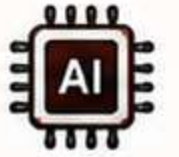
New competitor
enters the market



Competitors
start price wars



New government
regulations increase
compliance cost



New technology
makes your solution
outdated



KEY TAKEAWAY

Threats are real and can't be ignored. **Stay informed, stay prepared,** and **adapt quickly** to protect your business.



THE EASIEST WAY TO REMEMBER S W O T

**STRENGTH**



What are we good at?

**WEAKNESS**



Where are we struggling?

**OPPORTUNITY**



What external opportunity can we exploit?

**THREAT**



What external problem could hurt us?

STRENGTH + WEAKNESS = INTERNAL

Factors inside the business that we can control.

OPPORTUNITY + THREAT = EXTERNAL

Factors outside the business that we cannot control.

**KEY TAKEAWAY**

- ✓ Strength + Weakness = **Internal**
- ✓ Opportunity + Threat = **External**
- ✓ **Strength**: What are we good at?
- ✓ **Weakness**: Where are we struggling?
- ✓ **Opportunity**: What external opportunity can we exploit?
- ✓ **Threat**: What external problem could hurt us?



Don't worry about getting the exact answer. We're learning how to **think**.

POSSIBLE STRENGTH	POSSIBLE WEAKNESS	POSSIBLE OPPORTUNITY	POSSIBLE THREAT
 Strong consumer brand and established food-delivery platform.	 Dependence on external restaurant partners and delivery operations.	 Growth in online food ordering and expansion of related services.	 Strong competition and changing consumer preferences.



These aren't automatically "facts." Some are **analytical interpretations**. That's where research comes in.

FACT vs. INTERPRETATION

FACT (VERIFIABLE)

Suppose you find:

"Zomato operates across hundreds of cities."



This is a factual claim that can be verified.

INTERPRETATION (ANALYTICAL)

Now you say:

"Zomato's large geographic presence is a competitive advantage."



That's an interpretation. It may be reasonable, but you're making an analytical judgment.

**REMEMBER:**

Facts come from evidence. Conclusions come from analysis.

AI can help you with both. But you need to know which is which.

MAIN ACTIVITY — CREATE A SWOT ANALYSIS



Goal: Analyze a company's competitive position using research, verification, and critical thinking.

1. CHOOSE ONE COMPANY

Examples: Zomato, Swiggy, Nykaa, Flipkart, Amazon, Reliance, Tata, Netflix, Spotify, Tesla, Starbucks or any company you are interested in.



2. STEP 1 — ASK AI TO HELP YOU RESEARCH

Use this prompt:



- I am analyzing [COMPANY].
- Help me research its competitive position.
- Identify:
 - Major competitors
 - Target customers
 - Main products/services
 - Key differentiators
 - Major strengths
 - Potential weaknesses
 - Industry opportunities
 - External threats
- Separate:
 1. Verified facts
 2. Reasonable business interpretations
- Do not invent statistics or sources.
- Provide sources for important factual claims.

3. STEP 2 — VERIFY THE IMPORTANT CLAIMS

Pick three key claims from the AI response and verify each one.

#	CLAIM	QUESTIONS TO ASK	MY VERIFICATION NOTES
1		• Who is the source? • Is the source reliable? • Is the information recent? • Does the source actually support the claim?	
2		• Who is the source? • Is the source reliable? • Is the information recent? • Does the source actually support the claim?	
3		• Who is the source? • Is the source reliable? • Is the information recent? • Does the source actually	



Remember: Use what is verified. Question what is not. This connects to [Session 11 — AI Research & Fact Verification](#).

4. STEP 3 — BUILD YOUR SWOT



STRENGTHS (Internal)
2–3 internal advantages

STRENGTH	WHY? (Explanation)
1.	
2.	
3.	



Example: Strong brand → Why? It increases customer trust and recognition.



OPPORTUNITIES (External)
2–3 external opportunities

OPPORTUNITY	WHY? (Explanation)
1.	
2.	
3.	



Example: Growth in online shopping → Why? More customers are moving online.



WEAKNESSES (Internal)
2–3 internal limitations

WEAKNESS	WHY? (Explanation)
1.	
2.	
3.	



Example: Limited presence in tier-2 cities → Why? It restricts customer reach.



THREATS (External)
2–3 external threats

THREAT	WHY? (Explanation)
1.	
2.	
3.	



Example: Strong competition → Why? It can reduce market share and margins.

TIPS FOR DEEPER ANALYSIS



Be specific. Avoid generic points.



Always ask “Why?” to go deeper.



Focus on factors that truly impact the business.



Use evidence for facts and logic for interpretations.



The best SWOTs show insight, not just lists.



FINAL OUTPUT

Submit your completed SWOT with explanations (Why?) and a short note on 3 verified facts you found during your research.



Great analysis comes from good research + critical thinking!

LET'S MAKE IT MORE INTERESTING



Imagine you're the CEO of the company you selected.

Your SWOT contains this:

S STRENGTH



Strong brand

W WEAKNESS



High operating costs

O OPPORTUNITY



Growing demand

T THREAT



New low-cost competitor

Now I ask you:

What should the company do?



MAKE A DECISION



Use the **strong brand** to enter the **growing market** while **improving operational efficiency** to defend against the **low-cost competitor**.

EXAMPLES OF STRATEGIC ACTIONS



Leverage brand equity to attract more customers.



Reduce costs through process automation, tech, and supply chain optimization.



Expand product or service offerings in the growing market.



Differentiate on quality, experience, and reliability.



Innovate continuously to stay ahead of competitors.



STRATEGY = CHOICES + TRADE-OFFS + EXECUTION



AI vs. HUMAN THINKING

AI IS VERY GOOD AT:

- ✓ Collecting information
- ✓ Structuring information
- ✓ Comparing competitors
- ✓ Finding patterns
- ✓ Creating SWOT frameworks
- ✓ Summarizing reports



BUT AI DOESN'T AUTOMATICALLY KNOW:



What the company should actually do.

Suppose AI gives you:

- S** Strength: Strong brand
- W** Weakness: High costs
- O** Opportunity: Growing market
- T** Threat: New competitor

That's useful. But the manager still has to decide:



"What strategy should we implement?"

That requires:



Judgment



Context



Risk assessment



Business understanding



Creativity



Human decision-making



REMEMBER:

AI structures the analysis. **Humans** interpret the strategy.



GOOD LEADERS DON'T JUST ANALYZE THE BUSINESS — THEY **DECIDE THE FUTURE** OF THE BUSINESS.



! A COMMON SWOT MISTAKE

Students often put things in the wrong box.

Remember: **Internal** = Inside the company | **External** = Outside the company

✗ COMMON MISTAKE

S **STRENGTH**

Growing market

Why Wrong?

A growing market is external. The company does not control the market.

! **Wrong.** A growing market is NOT a strength.



✓ CORRECT PLACEMENT

O **OPPORTUNITY**

Growing market

Why Right?

A growing market is external and creates a favorable situation for the company.

✓ **Correct.** A growing market is an opportunity.

✗ COMMON MISTAKE

W **WEAKNESS**

Strong competition

Why Wrong?

Competition is external. The company cannot control competitors.

! **Wrong.** Strong competition is NOT a weakness.



✓ CORRECT PLACEMENT

T **THREAT**

Strong competition

Why Right?

Competition is external and could negatively impact the business.

✓ **Correct.** Strong competition is a threat.



THE GOLDEN RULE

Ask this simple question:

Does the company **CONTROL** it?

If YES → It is **INTERNAL**
(Strength or Weakness)



Does the **external environment** **CONTROL** it?

If YES → It is **EXTERNAL**
(Opportunity or Threat)



WHY THIS MATTERS

Putting items in the correct box leads to better analysis, better strategies, and better business decisions.



REMEMBER

INTERNAL



S

W

EXTERNAL



O

T



KEY TAKEAWAY:

Internal = Inside the company. External = Outside the company.

Get this right, and your SWOT analysis will be powerful and meaningful!

- ✓ Check the source of each point
- ✓ Place it in the right box
- ✓ Then build strategy from it

